

iPad vs. Windows 8 Tablet

Have a look on the head-to-head comparison of iPad and Windows 8 Tablet. You can even go for the comparison of iPad and Microsoft Surface RT. <http://dgit.in/13zhraR>



Seagate's Ultrathin HDD

Seagate introduces a 5mm world's thinnest 500GB HDD as an alternative to flash-based SSD. <http://dgit.in/14aZbqt>

Smartphones Test

on the Galaxy S III. The design isn't unibody, and while some may scoff at that, there are the positives of this design. The biggest being that you can access the battery pack, and that is a real bonus when the time comes to replace it with a new one. Imagine leaving your phone in a service center for a week just to get the battery replaced.

The Galaxy S4 feels very light in the hand, lighter than the HTC One. But, the Galaxy S4 does tend to slip around in the hand a bit too much for comfort, to be honest. The slippery back is something you will have to be very careful of, particularly with moist or sweaty hands.

All in all, preference of plastic over metal (and vice versa) is something that is very subjective, clearly explained by the massive sales figures of the Galaxy SIII and the Galaxy S4 – the biggest vote of confidence for any product and the easiest metric to gauge.

HTC One: Masterpiece. Exquisite.

The Apple iPhone 5 was the best built phone, till the HTC One came along. Without doubt, the One is a gorgeous smartphone, both in terms of its looks and build quality. The edge to edge glass at the front, the bevelled edges and the metal finish at the back, and the unibody design is something you need to experience to believe. It's thoughtfully put together, too, like the slight curve at the back to help with gripping the phone. Unlike the Galaxy S4's slippery back panel, the One sits securely in your grip. The non-slippery finish also brings with it a non-shiny matte finish, at least in the darker colour version.

However, we did notice the phone catching some scratches from keys and pens when kept

in the same pocket. Above the display is the well chiselled out earpiece grille, which has the front facing camera to one side. The same design and treatment is done to the microphone below the display glass.

Just below the One's display are two touchsensitive keys – Return and home / task manager. The HTC logo sitting between them seems a bit confusing, because it isn't a touch sensitive key! The volume keys sit on the right spine, and because HTC wanted to keep the keys flush, the design has ended up being too depressed. The micro USB port sits on the bottom spine. Because it is a unibody, the SIM card slot is on the top of the left spine, and the slot is fairly well disguised. The camera sits towards the top of the back panel, equidistant from either side. A strip of grey towards the top and the bottom of the back panel adds a distinct visual element.

Where the One has the undisputed lead over all the rivals is the quality of materials used, and how the unibody design has been improved so much further than all the other unibody phones before it.

BlackBerry Z10: Industrial and functional

The BlackBerry Z10 basically shouts out its simplicity. The flagship Blackberry device bears a striking resemblance with the Apple iPhone 5's overall design, but that is pretty much where the similarity ends.

Its clean look and what is an industrial design stands out amidst the colourful and eye-catching designs of Android and Windows Phone smartphones. While BlackBerry is appealing to a wider audience with the BB10 phones, it cannot alienate its core demographic

– the business/corporate user. The Z10's display is flanked by no hardware keys, making it a full-touch device. The phone's multitasking experience is similar to that on the BlackBerry Playbook. The panel around the screen is touch-enabled, allowing for swipe gestures that enable navigation through the BB10 user interface. This is the reason why the phone



HTC One

feels slightly bigger than most phones of the 4.2-inch or 4.3-inch display size. As for single hand operability along with the new interface, Z10 requires you to slightly shift the phone around in the hand to access the opposite side's top corner with the thumb, but that is equally true for the 4-inch iPhone 5 as well. The strip of matte black above and below the BlackBerry Z10's display contrasts well with the shiny nature of the glass on the screen. The grey grille on the earpiece is fairly noticeable. It is a refreshing change to actually get a top-end

smartphone where the battery cover opens and the battery is user accessible.

BlackBerry Q10: Old world charm is back, with a modern touch

This is the only smartphone in this test that has the good old physical QWERTY keyboard and a touchscreen combo. While everyone expected the Q10 to be the first BlackBerry 10 device to be launched, the company surprised everyone by launching the Z10 first.

At first glance, the Q10 is the true logical successor for the Bold Touch 9900 from the OS7 era. The stocky build is very comfortable to use because despite the slightly thick form factor, at 139 grams, it isn't a heavy phone. The non-slip textured finish on the back panel is immensely helpful in gripping the phone. The carbon weave casing on the back is light but strong. Each has a unique fingerprint in terms of design. One change from the older keyboards to this one is the completely straight layout. There is no curve going up at the two edges of the keyboard. This won't really have any impact on the typing experience though. There is literally no spacing between each key, and again, that does not hamper the user experience at all. Each key is big enough and has the ridge on every key to help the finger identify the correct place when you aren't looking down and typing.

Gone are the traditional call connect / disconnect and menu keys and the optical trackpad seen in the previous generation Bold series phones. The touchscreen does the job now, and the removal of these keys allows for a better spaced out keyboard and a slightly bigger display.